

DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT NOTES

What follows are some design insights and development tidbits from both myself and John Foley for *Combat Commander: Mediterranean*. We also include in this section some hints, tactics and strategies that we have learned along the way which may be of help in both your enjoyment and mastery of *CC*. John's walkthrough of the Random Scenario Generator (beginning on page 4) should be of particular interest for those of you wishing to try out that system for the first time.

Chad says:

Playing the British & Commonwealth—

"We were at the very peak of enthusiasm, fitness, training."

Major Dick Gosling

In World War II, the well-trained soldiers of the UK and their dominions were often characterized as being stolid when on the defense and methodical when attacking. Made up largely of volunteer forces – Britain herself notwithstanding – there appeared a slightly higher percentage of elite formations within the Commonwealth nations, though not quite of the elite standard generally assigned to a German SS or Russian Guards unit. However, the other side of the same coin shows that green formations belonging to the Commonwealth nations weren't exactly folks stripped from their homes and handed a rifle and a few rounds as they boarded a truck heading to the front lines. Even the newest recruits fighting for the Crown rarely upped and ran at the first nearby shell burst as many German Volksgrenadiers did; nor did they surrender en masse like the Russian masses in the first months of Barbarossa. To this end – with the exception of specialized units such as Airborne and Engineers Squads or the Weapon Teams – I have assigned Morale values of 7 to unbroken British Squads and Teams, eschewing the "normal" 8 or 6 Morale of an elite or green unit, respectively. The broken side of British elite and green units are then used to emphasize their relative eliteness or greenness.

How this translates to game play is: Treat your elite Guards units with a bit more care and consideration as they will break more readily than any other nation's elite squads (other than the Americans). Your Territorial units, however, can be thrown about with a bit more abandon than you can with most other faction's green units (similar to the Russian's Militia Squads).

The British Leader-to-Squad ratio of 1:3 ties Germany for best in the game. However, British OBs tend to favor a higher percentage of 1-Command Leaders so your formations will need to be a little tighter on the map in order to maintain command over as many friendly troops as possible. So a British OB will likely have a good number of quality officers and NCOs (compared to the number of non-Leaders) but not many outstanding ones.

As far as the British & Commonwealth Fate Deck is concerned, it has some interesting pluses and minuses. It has two fewer Fire Orders than average (16) but sports six Marksmanship Actions—so you will be taking fewer shots but of generally higher quality. This reflects the British emphasis on personal marksmanship as well as their particular form of steadfastness under fire. The renowned British honor, courage and dash on the battlefield is represented by having one extra Recover Order

in the deck (10 instead of the nominal 9) while also being able to generate more Heroes and suffer fewer Cower and Prisoners of War Events than the other factions.

Finally, with regards to weapons note that the British faction possesses the only Light Mortar capable of laying Smoke. Do not underestimate this ability, especially when on the attack and short of hexes possessing decent Cover (*cough* scenario 22 *cough*).

Playing the French & Allied Minors—

German conquest of Norway: April 9-June 9—sixty-one days

German conquest of France: May 10-June 21—forty-two days

German conquest of Greece: April 6-April 30—twenty-four days

German conquest of Belgium: May 10-May 28—eighteen days

German conquest of Yugoslavia: April 6-April 14—eight days

German conquest of Holland: May 10-May 14—four days

German conquest of Denmark: April 9—priceless

Based upon the above, it's not hard to see why this faction is assigned the unfortunate discard capability of only 1 card per Turn; the lowest in the game. One of the largest, most well-armed armies in the world – that of France – capitulated in only six weeks due in great part to a lack of élan, effective leadership at Staff rank and higher, initiative amongst NCOs and junior officers, and proper training in the art of modern warfare. The other nations listed above suffered more or less from the same maladies but also succumbed quickly due to the inconvenience of their small size and/or their positioning on the map of Europe: both of which were militating factors in their downfall. Finally, none of these nations had the luxury of time; of being able to learn from their political and military mistakes in order to create a more formidable army with which to fight back like the British did post Dunkirk, the Soviets after the winter of '41, or the US following the battle for Tunisia.

So how does a person playing the French lessen the impact of this rather severe drawback? First, if assigned the French & Allied Minors faction during a roll-your-own scenario, purchase an expensive Company: this will make it more likely that you are on the offense and thus get to fight with a six-card hand. If you find yourself as the scenario Defender, however, don't panic just yet: you *do* have quality units and a decent Fate Deck. One key is to spend cards for their Actions whenever possible! Burning through a card in this manner if you don't really need the Order on it is a good way to get a "free" discard and allow an extra card draw at the end of your turn. To this effect, note that most of the French Command Confusion Orders share their card with a Sustained Fire Action—so fire your MGs often and hold that trigger down! Also, don't be afraid to give unspectacular Orders. For example, Move one unit only one hex, or play Recover when it will only remove a lone Suppression marker. This allows the cards to flow through your hand that much quicker. When playing as the scenario Defender, a good rule of thumb – *especially* for the French faction – is to not give any Fire Orders on your own Turn unless you have a backup Fire card for your opponent's Turn in case he Moves: If you only have the one Fire card in hand, it is much more efficient to save it for Op Fire where you're likely to be able to get multiple shots off, thus increasing the potency of the single action. In this manner it is

often advantageous to just discard on your Turn and act on your opponent's.

Having said all this of course, you *will* eventually get stuck with a hand-o'-crap. At this point just grin and bear it as you discard one card at a time and hope that your opponent doesn't simultaneously have the über-hand with which to decimate your forces. Oh, and congratulations: you've just been forced to enter the mind-set of your real-world counterpart....

As alluded to already, the French forces in **CC** are no slouches: their unit and weapon stats are for the most part on par with those of the major factions from **CC:Europe**—especially in the all-important Morale department. The French Fate Deck is a bit weaker as far as Artillery goes; has little smoke-making capability; has little chance of getting air support; and will generally see a higher incidence of its weapons breaking when firing. It also has a high number of Command Confusion Actions, though most of these are paired with Rout Orders: so if there's a broken unit in play – enemy or friendly! – play the Rout just to cycle that weak card if nothing else. Who knows: you may actually be able to Retreat one of your own endangered units back into better Cover. Despite these minor drawbacks, the rest of the deck is quite robust when compared with the other nationalities.

Playing the Italians & Axis Minors—

...At a prewar diplomatic conference, German Foreign Minister Ribbentrop “sniffed” to Eden and Churchill that if there was another war, the Italians would be on Germany's side!

To which Churchill supposedly replied: “That seems only fair, we had them last time!”...

Ah, yes, the much maligned Italian troops of WWII. The truth is that man-for-man the average Italian soldier carried within himself the potential to display the same courage and derring-do as his counterparts. He just wasn't allowed much of a chance to do so given the rampant ineptitude of his nation's officer corps, lack of combat training, and a dearth of quality weaponry. The same can pretty much be said of Germany's Balkan allies – Rumania, Bulgaria and Hungary – which all fall under the umbrella of Axis Minors.

So how does this play into the Italian faction in **CC**? The Italian player will be saddled with a discard capability of only “2”—second worst after the French & Allied Minors. Their leader-to-squad ratio of only 1:6 is worst in the game. This means that there are likely to be plenty of Italian Squads and Teams outside Command Radius of a friendly Leader at any given moment, diluting the power of having the quantitative advantage over most foes. This drawback is felt less acutely when the Italians are assigned as the scenario Defender, so when selecting an OB for this faction during a roll-your-own scenario think “small and cheap”.

The Italian Fate Deck is the weakest amongst the Factions and should be played with care and thought. Your useful Orders and Actions are scarcer than for your opponent. You have one fewer Move Order (“we're staying put!”) and one fewer Rout Order (who runs from the Italian Army?). You dislike Melee with your units' smaller Firepower and fewer Ambush Actions. Your weapons will jam more often (6x **Jammed!**) and your sharpshooters will miss more often (only 5x **Sniper!**). Your Events are more likely to cause an Italian unit to Suppress or become a

P.O.W. while giving them fewer chances to become Veteran or to generate a Hero.

In **CC**, Italian Squads and Teams will tend to have standard Morale on their unbroken side but less-than-average Morale while broken. This – coupled with a high rate of Cower and Prisoners of War Events in their Fate Deck – reflects the Italian soldier's propensity for ducking out of a fight once the brown stuff hits the fan. Their lower overall Firepower and Range speak to their aforementioned shortage of quality weaponry as well as their serious lack of military training—something that was nowhere close to being on par with what a German, British or US soldier went through before seeing their first combat situation. What this means in game play is this: keep your units in Cover more often than you would for other factions; keep your units away from enemy units—they are usually the underdog in Melee and, when broken, are more likely to become POWs; and try to always keep at least one Recover Order in hand as you will soon discover that a scenario utilizing Italian forces where there isn't at least one broken Italian unit at any given moment is a rare thing indeed.

The Italians had some of the worst-designed weapons of WWII and this is reflected in their **CC** arsenal. For example, many of their machine guns used the weak 6.5mm round rather than the 7.62mm or 7.92mm bullet favored by other nations. Their light mortar – the Brixia model 35 – was similarly undersized at only 45mm compared to other countries using 50-60mm squad mortars. Another example is that Italian machine guns had a problem with the extraction of spent cartridges. Their answer for this was a self-oiling mechanism for each shell as it entered the gun: not the best solution as this made it so that the slickened rounds brought grit and mud and dirt into the chamber with them, causing all sorts of short-term jams and long-term wear. This is part of the reason for the Italian Fate Deck's high number of **Jammed!** results; that and their chronic lack of ammunition—a functioning gun is a useless gun with no more bullets to feed it.

Now with all this doom-and-gloom concerning the Italian faction you're probably thinking “why would anyone want to play them?” For the sake of a good challenge, of course! Just kidding. The main benefit of playing the Italian & Axis Minor faction is that all of their pieces are *cheap* (take a look at the VP costs for their units, weapons and radios as compared to everyone else's on page 6 of this booklet). What this means is that they are usually the scenario Defender, with all of its inherent strengths tailor-made for the Italian faction: one free VP each Turn; fewer dead cards in hand as all of those “Defender Only” Actions become usable; don't need to do too much moving and advancing so get to sit tight in hexes with high Cover; sheer numbers that make it that much harder for the scenario Attacker to get by you for Exit VPs; extra units lying about in a quiet sector so that you can sneak one off of the Attacker's board edge for a some Exit VPs of your own.

Is it difficult to play the Italian Faction well? Yep. Is it possible to win with them? Absolutely; and you'll have a heck of good time finding out how to do so.

Playing the Finns—The glaring exception to much of the above negativity are the Finnish forces that are also found within the Italian & Axis Minor faction (as they were, technically, an Axis Minor nation). The Finns fought gallantly and skillfully

and – though usually outnumbered – bested the Russian juggernaut time and time again. To help reflect their quality within a faction geared for quite the opposite I have allowed a player commanding a Finnish OB to discard up to one card *even if he has given one or more Orders during the same Turn!* Fans of the card wargame **Up Front** will recognize this ability for what it is: powerful, versatile, flexible. This ability is coupled with the minor drawback of getting one fewer allowed Orders than a similarly-sized OB. These two special rules taken together help reflect the Finnish soldier's unique trait of "sisu"—roughly translated as individualism and initiative.

The Finnish Army's predilection for hit and run tactics rather than fighting pitched battles is further reflected in the Movement rate of 6 for this faction's "Sissi" Squad: the highest in the game for any non-Leader unit. This means that a Sissi can traverse three Woods hexes in the time it takes their Russian adversary to cross two, helping to reinforce their familiarity with skis, inurement to harsh winter conditions, and overall stealthy demeanor. Note also the broken-side Movement stat of 2 for the Sissi Squads. This allows them to Move into a Woods or Building hex even when broken. The Sissi Squad also has an unbroken/broken Morale arrangement of 8/9—it's hard to break them and then, if you do and they're in any sort of cover, are likely to rally right back.

Using Molotov Cocktails—Finally, note that a Finnish OB comes complete with everyone's favorite psuedo-weapon: the Molotov Cocktail. This is a tasty little piece that can be quite dangerous when used intelligently. Note that MCs negate all Cover like a Flamethrower *and* are single-use weapons like a Satchel Charge; but MCs lack a white band and therefore are *not* Ordnance. This means that an MC can be used in a Fire Group to negate the defending units' Terrain (even if only that once) or could perform its own Fire Attack with the attendant Command bonus provided by a friendly Leader stacked in the same hex. Some may cry foul at the notion of an MC having a Range of 3 when it's possessing unit happens to be stacked with a 2-Command Leader ("nobody can throw a lit vodka bottle 100 meters!")—my response is three words long as I wring my hands together in evil glee: *prepared booby trap*.

And why, you may wonder, are the Molotov Cocktail counters a different color than any other piece in the game?

I'm not telling.

Yet.

John says:

Key Tools—

Initiative—The Initiative card is your friend but if you don't let it go, you'll smother it. It was not meant to sit chained to your side of the board although there are plenty of times when you need to keep it near you. Here's an example: if you are likely to lose a Melee but it's not a game-breaker to lose it, you shouldn't automatically hold the Initiative. There are other factors to consider. Do you have a Weapon in that Melee (losing Weapons is serious)? Do you have at least an even chance of rolling a better result (play the odds)? Which of you stands to lose more positional energy with the loss (if the hole in his line will be worse than the hole in your line)? If you find any edge in these other factors, you should use the Initiative to force the re-roll. If the odds are longer than you'd like but the loss of that Melee is going to seriously compromise your position, you probably have to use the Initiative. Naturally you'll prefer to use it to turn the tables at just the right moment. You've got to practice using it a lot in order to be able to discern those right moments.

Card Flow—Effective flow of cards through your hand is the key to developing sufficient command energy to accomplish your mission. The emphasis on card flow in this design reveals how the classic OODA loop (Observe, Orient, Decide, Act) of command decision is not a static idea. You are released from seeing command problems in phased steps. However, without practice in playing, discarding or saving your options in rapid sequence you can bog down and drown in your decision making processes—and your opponent will have gotten inside your OODA loop. If your plans have gone awry, insisting on only one way out will end your game. Developing effective card flow through repeated play will break you out of the traps that you place in front of yourself. *Go with the Flow*.

Combat School—

It is likely that tournaments will use published scenarios that develop a reputation over time as being very balanced (after being played countless times by many people). In any one given playing, however, you will be subjected to a wide variety of variations and changes to that scenario.

Q: How do you prepare yourself?

A: You go to Combat School.

Q: And how do you apply to this prestigious learning institute?

A: By using the **CC** Random Scenario Generator (RSG).

The RSG allows you to test yourself with historically tailored forces in diverse settings and encounters. The forces range from Platoon to Detachment to Company formations appropriate for different nationalities, levels of training and time periods during the war. This means that you can try platoon-to-platoon meetings or find out whether a French platoon can defeat a German company in 1939. You can find out how different kinds of terrain will suit the force you have and whether some forces are more effective on the defense than on the attack—perhaps you'll discover some of your own leadership style as well.

When you first try out the RSG, you might not want to subject yourself to just any nationality that gets rolled up so, by all means, if you and your opponent think something you just

rolled up is guaranteed to be a failure avoid the potential aggravation and don't play it out. Just start over!

That said, here are some tips for those of you that are new to the **Combat Commander** system to help you get started in Combat School. At first, I recommend that you guide or even predetermine some of the choices you make as you randomly generate your scenarios. Later on, when you've gained competence, you can look forward to working with more difficult situations.

RS.1 Battlefield—Don't pick a map you are not interested in or that represents more difficult terrain-type challenges than you want to handle at the moment. Save the desert or the heavy mountains or the bocage for Advanced Combat School.

RS.2 Axis & Allies—Try a particular nationality or avoid a specific nationality. At first, the Axis player should perhaps pick Germany (but still roll for the year) and then the Allied player should pick America, Britain or Russia. By all means, choose the nationality you want to play and avoid the ones you don't. There may be times when you simply don't want to have the Axis be German and the Allies Russian *again*. There are other times when the thought of playing the valiant Poles against the German machine is depressing. Don't get stuck, pick the sides.

RS.3 Troop Quality—Roll for troop quality normally, but perhaps decide to re-roll if you get Green. It's hard enough working with Line troops, but Green troops are very brittle and require a lot of expertise to command effectively. Avoid frustration; save them for later.

RS.4 Objectives—This is one step in which you should follow the procedure as written—just pick 'em from the draw cup. Almost every historical scenario faces you with randomized objectives, so you should need to face them in Combat School as well.

RS.5 Orders of Battle—This requires judgment; unless both players want to try platoons, agree to skip platoon formations at first so you can both work with two or three leaders—save the single leader stuff for Advanced Combat School. If you really want to keep parity in the experience, decide on Company-to-Company or Detachment-to-Detachment sized OBs. However, you might be pleasantly surprised to discover that the Company-vs-Platoon engagements are very exciting to play, giving a definite Attacker and a definite Defender. The Attacker will have the chance to receive Artillery (RS.11) and the Defender is likely to have fun purchasing from the Fortification table (RS.9). If the VP value of both OBs is very close, the Support Rolls (RS.7) may change the player roles from Attacker to Defender and vice versa.

RS.6 Leaders—Just as with Objectives, you should avoid picking your favorite and just roll for your Leaders per the procedure. You'll need to find out how to command forces with Corporals Cassidy, Singh, Boudreau, Winkler, Aprile and Gerdov at one time or another.

RS.7 Support Rolls—You may end up disliking the results but I would say "just roll 'em". I rarely found that I got exactly what I wanted on this roll. Treat this area as one of your key learning variables in Combat School. Think about the strengths and weaknesses of the options you have, and then make choices for a reason and test how they work out. I've been placed on the horns of a dilemma at this step, with lower grade troops or fewer tools than I want. Sometimes one more Squad is more

valuable than another Weapon; sometimes one more leader is more valuable than a Weapon Team with a Mortar. Accepting the results at this point is an important step in your training.

RS.8 Posture—This step was already determined by which OBs were chosen and how you and your opponent decided to spend your available VPs on Support Rolls. Later on, you might try your hand at forcing a Recon situation with two smaller sized OBs of similar VP cost.

RS.9 Fortifications—The Defender goes to the big department store on the back page of this booklet. You have to decide whether the situation and forces merit spending your VPs to get fortifications to channel the attack and strengthen key points—or saving them all as a bank fund to put pressure on the Attacker. That's often a hard choice to make. The key variables here have to do with how great the disparity is between the flexibility and resilience of your force versus that of your opponent. If you have a somewhat rigid and brittle force compared to your opponent, you'll need to consider investing in fortifications very seriously. If you're more evenly matched, you may value VPs in the bank more readily.

RS.10–RS.13 Set Up—This leaves one last challenge in Combat School. The scenario you and your opponent have just created is one you have not seen before. You are familiar with the elements of the situation—the nationalities, the types of units available in the OBs, the maps. You are *not* familiar with the combination of these elements. The challenge is to develop your assessment ability by deciding to set up as rapidly as you can. Sorting units into groups led by Leaders is rather simple, but it depends on how you read the situation presented to you by the dice. Make it your goal to evaluate your force and mission and deploy in five minutes or less.

RS.11.1 Asset Request—Time to beef up the Attacker's arsenal a bit. Note that this step is not a one-sided benefit to the Attacker. While Artillery can be very powerful, it can distract an Attacker into waiting for a successful result before moving forward. If you do not want to play a scenario with Artillery, simply pass on this option. Your Order of Battle will have already been set at this point, so following this step is a matter of your interests and of course training goals. There are challenges playing scenarios with and without Artillery.

RS.14–RS.16—These last steps in the RSG process are straightforward and should be followed literally.

RS.16+—Finally, remember the most important rule: understand your purpose and use the RSG to support that purpose. If you're testing certain terrain conditions or certain forces or disparities in forces, it makes sense to pre-designate your choices. If you're looking for hardboiled preparation for tournament play, take what you get and make it work. If you're just looking for some light fun for an afternoon, make sure to agree with your opponent on parameters that you'll both enjoy.

Follow the unofficial official **CC** motto: *Go with the Flow*.

RANDOM SCENARIO GENERATOR

*Note that the three factions included in **Combat Commander: Mediterranean** are actually made up of several nations.*

*For example: If a table on this page assigns a player the role of “France”, it is actually allowing the player to select any of the OBs belonging to the various nationalities found on the **French (& Allied Minor) Order of Battle** player aid sheet. Similarly, a player assigned the role of “Britain” may select any nationality found on the **British (& Commonwealth) Order of Battle** table, while a player assigned the role of “Italy” may select any OB found on the **Italian (& Axis Minor) Order of Battle** table.*

Thus throughout this playbook and the player aids “British”, “French” and “Italian” are each used solely as terms of convenience to represent a larger body of nations.

To generate a random scenario utilizing both Volume I and Volume II, players should shuffle up a couple of Fate Decks to use for die rolls (or just grab a couple of dice from another game). Then perform the following sequence in the exact order shown.

RS.1 Battlefield

Have one player make a roll: if “even” that player selects any one available map to use; if “odd” the other player chooses the map. Then the player who *did not* select the map places it in the center of the playing surface and makes another roll, selecting either the white die OR the colored die. He then rotates the map so that the compass direction matching the chosen die faces him (which will become his friendly board edge).

So a chosen die showing 2 or 3 puts the map’s right side closest to him; 5 or 6 gives him the map’s left side; 1 is the top edge; 4 is the bottom.

Place the Track Display along the side of the map. Place the VP marker on the “0” space of the Victory Track.

RS.2 Axis and Allies

RS.2.1 Year & Axis Nationality

Either player flips a coin: “heads” he plays the Axis; “tails” the Allies.

The Axis player then makes a roll to determine his nationality: “2-9” he will play Germany; “10-12” Italy.

The Axis player then makes a roll to determine the year:

2. Germany: 1939 / Italy: 1942
3. Germany: 1943 / Italy: 1943
4. Germany: 1940 / Italy: 1939
5. Germany: 1945 / Italy: 1944
6. Germany: 1941 / Italy: 1943
7. Germany: 1942 / Italy: 1940
8. Germany: 1943 / Italy: 1941
9. Germany: 1944 / Italy: 1942
10. Germany: 1944 / Italy: 1941
- 11-12. Germany: 1944 / Italy: 1942

Place the Year marker on the appropriate space of the Year Track.

RS.2.2 Allied Nationality (Axis is Germany)

Allied player rolls on the following table to determine his side’s nationality if the Axis player is Germany:

vs Germany							
Roll:	1939	1940	1941	1942	1943	1944	1945
2	France	France	France	Russia	France	France	France
3	France	France	France	Russia	America	Russia	Russia
4	France	France	France	Russia	America	America	America
5	France	France	Russia	Russia	America	America	America
6	France	France	Russia	Russia	Russia	America	America
7	France	France	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia
8	France	France	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia
9	France	Britain	Britain	Britain	Russia	Russia	Russia
10	France	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain
11	France	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain
12	France	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain	Britain

RS.2.3 Allied Nationality (Axis is Italy)

Allied player rolls on the following table to determine his side’s nationality if the Axis player is Italy:

vs Italy (& Axis Minors)						
Roll:	1939	1940	1941	1942	1943	1944
2	France	France	France	Britain	Britain	Russia
3	Russia	France	France	Britain	Britain	Russia
4	Russia	France	France	Britain	Britain	Russia
5	Russia	France	Britain	Britain	America	Russia
6	Russia	France	Britain	Britain	America	Russia
7	Russia	Britain	Britain	Russia	America	Russia
8	Russia	Britain	Britain	Russia	America	Russia
9	Russia	Britain	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia
10	Russia	Britain	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia
11	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia
12	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia	Russia

RS.3 Troop Quality

RS.3.1 Axis Quality

Axis player rolls on the appropriate table below to determine the Axis OB’s quality:

German Troop Quality				
Roll:	1939-41	1942	1943-44	1945
2-4	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite
5	Elite	Elite	Elite	Line
6	Elite	Elite	Line	Line
7-8	Line	Line	Line	Line
9-10	Line	Line	Line	Green
11	Line	Line	Green	Green
12	Line	Green	Green	Green

Italian (& Axis Minor) Troop Quality				
Roll:	1939 vs non-Russian	1940-43 vs non-Russian	1939-40 vs Russia	1941-44 vs Russia
2-4	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite
5	Elite	Line	Elite	Elite
6-8	Elite	Line	Elite	Line
9-11	Elite	Green	Elite	Line
12	Elite	Green	Elite	Green

RS.3.2 Allied Quality

Allied player rolls on the appropriate table below to determine the Allied OB's quality:

American Troop Quality			
Roll:	1943	1944	1945
2-3	Elite	Elite	Elite
4	Line	Elite	Elite
5-8	Line	Line	Elite
9-10	Green	Line	Line
11	Green	Green	Line
12	Green	Green	Green

British (& Commonwealth) Troop Quality					
Roll:	1940	1941-42	1943	1944	1945
2-4	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite
5	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite	Line
6	Line	Elite	Elite	Elite	Line
7	Line	Line	Elite	Elite	Line
8	Line	Line	Line	Elite	Line
9	Line	Line	Line	Line	Line
10-11	Green	Line	Line	Line	Green
12	Green	Green	Green	Green	Green

French (& Allied Minor) Troop Quality				
Roll:	1939	1940	1941	1943-45
2-5	Line	Elite	Line	Elite
6-7	Line	Line	Line	Elite
8-9	Line	Line	Green	Elite
10-12	Line	Green	Green	Elite

Russian Troop Quality						
Roll:	1939-40	1941	1942	1943	1944	1945
2-3	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite
4	Elite	Line	Elite	Elite	Elite	Elite
5	Line	Line	Line	Elite	Elite	Elite
6	Line	Line	Line	Line	Line	Elite
7-8	Line	Line	Line	Line	Line	Line
9	Line	Green	Line	Line	Line	Line
10	Line	Green	Green	Line	Line	Line
11	Line	Green	Green	Green	Line	Line
12	Line	Green	Green	Green	Green	Line

RS.4 Objectives

To form a "draw cup" for random selection, place the 22 Objective chits into an opaque container (such as a clean, dry coffee cup).

Either player draws one (face-up) "open" Objective at random. Place it in the central section of the Objective Chits box on the Track Display.

Then each player draws one (face-down) "secret" Objective at random. Place them in their appropriate sections of the Objective Chits box.

RS.5 Order of Battle

Each light-gray OB chit lettered A through J matches one specific OB on both the German and Italian Order of Battle tables. Each dark-gray OB chit lettered R through Z matches one specific OB on each of the American, British, French and Russian tables.

Each player refers to his assigned faction's Order of Battle Table and secretly selects *one* OB that he wishes to play; finding the OB chit with the same size and letter designation as the chosen OB and hiding it behind his cupped hand. Players then simultaneously reveal their selections. The chosen OB must match the nationality, year and troop quality as determined on this and/or the previous page.

Alternately, players could just jot down their selections on a scrap of paper.

The Axis player moves the VP marker a number of spaces along the Victory Track towards his opponent using the listed **Point Value** of his purchased OB. The Allied player then does the same with the VP marker but in the opposite direction.

RS.6 Leaders

Each side rolls once on its column of the Leader Table (located on the back page of this booklet) for *each* Leader listed in its OB, reading the *white die only*. For each Leader roll, add or subtract any relevant modifiers listed below the Table. If a player's subsequent Leader roll results in a Leader with the same name as one gained with a previous roll, re-roll until the result is an unused Leader.

Players now gather up their rolled Leaders as well as all allotted units and markers listed in the column of their purchased OBs. Place these off to the side for now—they will be set up shortly.

RS.7 Support Rolls

If the VP marker is in the "0" space, skip this step and proceed directly to step RS.8. Otherwise:

First, the player with the lower-cost OB (that is, the VP marker is on his side of the "0" space) makes a roll: he then *must* purchase one or more available units – *not* Radios – from that column of his nationality's Support Table. Purchased unit(s) must match the scenario's year and must still be available in the counter mix.

Note that multiple purchases are now allowed – even of the same unit – but that Radios can no longer be selected (which are now available only during step 11 on the following page).

He then moves the VP marker a number of spaces towards his opponent as the total listed cost of any purchased unit(s) (the **bold** number above the date).

Then, if – and *only* if – the second player now has the most VPs (that is, the marker *passed* by the "0" space onto that other player's side of the Victory Track), the second player makes a roll and *must* purchase one or more available units from that column of his nationality's Support Table. Purchased unit(s) must match the scenario's year and still be available in the counter mix. He then moves the VP marker a number of spaces towards his opponent as the total listed cost of any purchased unit(s).

Finally, both players gather up any purchased Support units (and their assigned Weapons, if any) and place them alongside their existing pile of OB counters. During initial setup, a Weapon acquired via a player's Support Table must be assigned to its accompanying unit, while any lone unit acquired via a player's Support Table cannot have an OB Weapon assigned to it.

RS.8 Posture

The player with the higher VP count at this point (that is, the one that has spent the fewest VPs so far, leaving the VP marker on his side of "0") becomes the "Defender" and the other player becomes the "Attacker". If the VP marker occupies the "0" space, both player's Posture will be "Recon" instead.

Each player should now find his faction's OB Stats marker listing the appropriate Posture and place it on the space of the OB Display (bottom left of the Track Display) that coincides with the listed **Orders** and **Quality** of his purchased OB.

To serve as an easy reminder during play, each of the OB Stats markers included in CC:M show one of the three Postures. Replacement OB Stats markers have also been provided for Germany, America and Russia (found on the back of the Italian, British and French OB Stats markers, respectively).

RS.9 Fortifications

The Defender (only) may now spend up to X points on one or more Fortification OBs (on the back page of this booklet), where X equals the Defender's current VP total. Any mix of Fortification OBs may be purchased – countermix permitting – with the exception of Minefields of *differing* strengths: if multiple Minefields are purchased they must be of the same strength. VPs spent on Fortification OBs are subtracted from the Defender's VP total (that is, move the VP marker towards the Attacker).

RS.10 Defender Sets Up

The Defender now sets up his purchased units/Weapons within 8 hexes of his friendly board edge (that is, within the first 8 hex rows) if the board orientation is 'wide'; or up to 12 hexes deep if the board orientation is 'narrow'. Stacking restrictions must be observed. *Keep any Fortifications set aside for now: they will be set up in a later step.*

Place a control marker (Defender's side up) in *every* Objective on the map. Adjust VPs accordingly for any open Objective(s).

RS.11 Attacker Sets Up

RS.11.1 Asset Request—First, the Attacker may choose to make a roll on his faction's Support Table. If he does, he *must* purchase one available *Radio* (only) from that column of the Support Table, if possible (that is, if the Radio on that column matches the scenario's year). If a Radio is purchased in this manner, the Attacker moves the VP marker a number of spaces towards his opponent as the listed cost of that Radio.

RS.11.2 Deployment—The Attacker now sets up his purchased units/markers within 2 hexes of his friendly board edge (that is, within the first two hex rows) if the board orientation is 'wide'; or up to 3 hexes deep if the board orientation is 'narrow'. Stacking restrictions must be observed. Any acquired Radio is placed in his Artillery Box.

If the Attacker sets up in any Objectives that are *not* also occupied by an enemy unit, flip the Control marker therein over to the Attacker's side. Adjust VPs accordingly for any open Objective chit(s).

RS.12 Fortification Setup

If the Defender purchased any Fortifications, he sets them up now—up to 8 hexes deep for a wide map, 12 hexes deep if narrow.

RS.13 Recon Sets Up

In a Recon scenario, the player with the higher **Initiative** (listed within his purchased OB on his nation's OB Table) must set up his forces first. He sets up his purchased units/markers within 4 hexes of his friendly board edge (that is, within the first 4 hex rows) if the board orientation is 'wide'; or up to 6 hexes deep if the board orientation is 'narrow'. Then the player with the lower Initiative sets up; and up to 4 or 6 hexes deep, as appropriate. Stacking restrictions must be observed.

Each player then places a control marker (his side up) in any Objective in which he has a unit and his opponent does not. Adjust VPs accordingly for any matching open Objective chit(s).

RS.14 Markers

- **Time:** Place the Time marker in the "0" space of the Time Track.
- **Sudden Death:** Determine the possible Game End by adding the number of Axis Orders allowed to the number of Allied Orders allowed (as marked earlier on the OB Display)—this will result in a number between 3 and 10. Place the Sudden Death marker into this space of the Time Track.
- **Surrender:** Each player places a Surrender marker in the space on his side of the Casualty Track matching the number indicated at the bottom of his purchased OB.
- **Mines:** If the Defender purchased one or more Fortification OBs containing 7- or 8-strength Mines, place the Minefields marker – with the appropriate "7" or "8" side face-up – so that it covers up the default "6-FP" box on the Track Display (adjoining the Mines data box).
- **Smoke/Blaze:** To form a second draw cup, place all of the Smoke/Blaze markers into an opaque container in order that they may be randomly drawn when needed during play.

RS.15 Cards

- **Initiative:** The player with the higher Initiative (listed in his purchased OB on his faction's Order of Battle Table) begins the game in control of the Initiative card. Place the Initiative card in front of that player as a reminder of initial ownership.
- **Fate:** Each player shuffles his nationality's 72 Fate cards together to form a face-down draw pile. Any OB selected off the "British (& Commonwealth)" OB chart uses the tan British Fate Deck. An OB selected off the "French (& Allied Minor)" OB chart uses the blue French Fate Deck. An OB selected off the "Italian (& Axis Minor)" OB chart uses the light green Italian Fate Deck. Each player then draws a number of Fate cards off the top of his deck equal to his Posture's matching hand size: 6 if Attack; 5 if Recon; or 4 if Defend.

RS.16 H-Hour

Finally, the side in possession of the Initiative card takes the first Turn of the game.

Design-your-own Point Values

piece	America	Britain	France	Germany	Italy	Russia
<i>Leader-to-Squad ratio</i>	1:4	1:3	1:4	1:3	1:6	1:5
Captain	443	561	371	597	246	344
Lieutenant [2-Cd]	382	484	320	515	212	296
Lieutenant [1-Cd]	304	385	254	409	169	236
Sergeant [2-Cd]	326	413	273	439	181	253
Sergeant [1-Cd]	252	320	211	340	140	196
Corporal [7-Mr]	206	261	172	277	114	160
Corporal [6-Mr]	164	208	137	221	91	127
Private	228	288	191	307	126	177
Hero	336	425	281	452	186	260
“Elite” Squad	137 [Engineer] 141 [Paratroop] 125 [Elite]	139 [Engineer] 131 [Airborne] 97 [Guards]	101 [BAR] 92 [Legionnaire]	154 [SS] 148 [Pionier] 125 [Elite Rifle] 123 [Parachute]	106 [Sissi] 98 [Guastatori] 79 [Bersaglieri]	139 [Assault] 115 [Guards SMG] 103 [Guards Rifle]
“Line” Squad	114 [Line]	84 [Line]	69 [Chasseur]	100 [Rifle] 83 [Volks.]	58 [Fucilieri]	89 [SMG] 79 [Rifle]
“Green” Squad	78 [Green]	70 [Territorial]	52 [Reservist]	63 [Conscript]	42 [Blackshirt]	61 [Militia]
Weapon Team	73	78	66	83	50	79
Elite Team	96	69	71	86	57	71
Line Team	73	59	49	64	34	54
Green Team	52	50	34	45	22	40
Light MG		44	30	62	30	35
Medium MG	84				65	74
Heavy MG	108	101	81	123	86	105
.50cal MG	125					122
Light Mortar	87	62	59 [50mm] 73 [60mm]	71	46 [Brixia] 56 [GrW] 71 [Brandt]	79
Medium Mortar	105	86	88	107	86	102
Gun	119 [Pack Howitzer]	109 [25-Pounder]	88 [French ‘75’]	137 [IG 33] 111 [IG 18]	80 [Mountain Gun]	110 [Infantry Gun]
Satchel Charge	37	36	31	38	30	36
Flamethrower	79	76		81	65	77
Molotov Cocktail	23	22	19	23	18	22
13-FP Radio	700	575				
12-FP Radio	700	496	418	510	326	334
11-FP Radio		429		440		334
10-FP Radio	521	429	262	380	243	
9-FP Radio	439	361	262	320	205	243
8-FP Radio	364	300	217	265	138	201
Foxhole	31					
Trench	62					
Bunker	124					
6-FP Mines	60					
7-FP Mines	90					
8-FP Mines	120					
Wire	33					

SCENARIO DESIGN HINTS

Situation Report—Determine your scenario's date and location based upon the battle you have chosen to depict. Write a short historical introduction.

Map—Use one of the existing CC maps or devise one of your own design. A CC map must *always* have:

- 150 hexes in a 10x15 grid, lettered A through O and numbered 1 through 10
- five Objectives numbered 1 through 5

Assign the Axis one map edge as “friendly” (the other side will be friendly to the Allies).

Squads—For Company-sized formations, German and British OBs should have about 9 Squads; American and French, 12; Russian, 15; and Italian 18. Two-thirds of these numbers would represent a Detachment and one-third a Platoon. A mix of Squad types is often advantageous in representing a particular formation's OB. The battle being depicted will, of course, dictate variance from this norm but these figures are still a good starting point.

Leaders—You will need to select specific Leaders for your forces. You usually want to assign three Leaders to a Company-sized force, two for Detachment and one for a Platoon. This gives a 1:3 Leader-to-Squad ratio for Germany and Britain; 1:4 for America and France; 1:5 for Russia; and 1:6 for Italy. When multiple Leaders have identical stats but different names, first select those listed on the Leader Table before choosing Leaders listed on that nation's Support Table (this will allow for the greatest number of possible Leaders to be available during Reinforcements / Infiltration Events).

Teams & Weapons—Determine any Weapons you want to include in the OB. One Weapon Team should usually accompany every HMG, Medium Mortar or Gun assigned. Elite, Line and Green Teams can be assigned based upon the historical content of the Company being modelled. Your sum total of non-Weapon Teams should usually not exceed roughly one-fourth of your Squad count; and even then only in Elite formations.

Artillery—In battles of the size portrayed in CC, artillery should be a rare occurrence. If you do decide on including artillery, try not to give a Radio to the side that will be the Scenario Defender as most every “Scenario Defender Only” Action share its card with Artillery Request Orders.

Surrender—The basic Surrender level for each side is a percentage of that side's total number of units (Leaders + Squads + Teams):

- 70% for a Company-sized formation;
- 75% for a Detachment-sized formation;
- 80% for a Platoon-sized formation.

Round to the nearest whole number (halves rounding as you see fit). This final number can of course be adjusted up or down based upon historical considerations.

Beginning VPs—Add up the total Point Values of each unit, weapon, radio and fortification for each side (including reductions for any **Reinforcements**, below) then divide these sums by 100 to arrive at the two sides' final “Point Totals”. The

difference between these two Point Totals is the number of VPs the lower side will begin the game with (round fractions down).

Initiative & Posture—The Initiative card should be assigned to the side with the higher Point Total, which should also usually be assigned the “Attack” Posture (and the opposing side “Defend”). If there is *less than* 1 difference between the Point Totals, both sides should usually be assigned the posture of “Recon:” in this case the Initiative should be given to the side having the *lower* Point Total and the VP marker will begin in the “0” space. Based upon the situation being depicted, however, there is nothing to stop you from assigning Recon vs Defender or Defender vs Defender or any other combination.

Quality—A side's Troop Quality should match its most common quality of Squad (elite, line or green; as indicated on the table to the left). For example, a German force comprising 5x SS Squads and 6x Rifle Squads would be deemed to have a “Line” Troop Quality.

Orders—The “Order Limit” for each side should generally be the number of Leaders it possesses, +1.

Time—You usually want to have the Time marker start in the “0” space of the Time Track. The Sudden Death marker should then be assigned to the space of the Time Track equal to 2 plus the sum of the number of Leaders on both sides.

Reinforcements—Any piece that will begin a scenario on the Time Track has its Point Value adjusted as follows: multiply its base Point Value (as given in the table to the left) by X-Y, where X is the number in the space of the Time Track where the Sudden Death marker is to be placed and Y is the space where the piece is to be placed; then divide *this* result by X to arrive at the unit's final adjusted Point Value.

For example, a German Rifle Squad (100 points) that will be placed on the 3 space with the Sudden Death marker in the 7 space will have an actual cost of 57:

$$(100*(X-Y))/X = (100*(7-3))/7 = (100*4)/7 = 400/7 = 57.$$

Objective Chits—Any known Objectives that you would like for the scenario should be assigned as “Open”. Assign “random” chits to one or both sides if you wish the scenario to have more open-ended victory goals. Note that any open Objectives beginning in one side's set up area will cause the VP marker's starting space (as determined above) to be adjusted.

Set Up—If your mapboard is to be “wide” with respect to the players, the Defender usually sets up 8 hexes deep and the attacker 2. For a “narrow” board, this changes to 12 and 3, respectively. For a Recon scenario, both sides should be assigned equal, fairly shallow depths (be careful about assigning a depth where they could theoretically begin the game set up adjacent to each other—“5” and “5” on a wide map, for example).

Special Rules—This is where you season your scenario and give it its flavor. Use this space for everything subtle and overt; weak and near-broken; flavorful and mechanical. Don't be afraid to bend and break one or more basic rules of the game here; just don't go overboard with this as basic play balance could become an issue. As far as quantity goes, a few good special rules always trumps a lot of mediocre ones. Also note that many Special Rules will be powerful enough to cause an adjustment in the starting VPs—use your best judgment here.